

Classroom SEL pack, a week on asking and listening, ages 3 to 7

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Ask first circle	Partners take turns asking each other one question (‘What do you like to play?’) and listening to the whole answer before talking. Then each child tells the class one new…	Page 8
Day 5 Roll backwards like Sabu	Roll backwards like Sabu, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Belonging and Contributing, Problem Solving and Innovating, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours, Self-Regulation and Well-Being

Materials

The book (or the class screen), a small ball, a dark blanket or a box with holes for stars, sticky notes

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English, French, Spanish, German, Italian.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: What is the beetle doing? Why might a beetle know about the stars? Ask: What is something you know a lot about? Now, what is something you would like to ask a friend? Notice the difference together. Teach the refrain: roll your hands, then point up. ‘Roll, roll, look up!’ And every time Kemi’s crest pops, everyone says ‘Pop!’

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
3	Kemi tells everyone how to do things; her friends go quiet.	Why did Kemi’s friends stop talking when she came near?	there was no room for their words, she always talked
4	Kemi tells Sabu he is pushing the wrong way.	What question could Kemi have asked Sabu?	why do you look up? how do you do it?
5	Every dune looks the same; Kemi is lost.	How does Kemi feel now?	scared, lost, worried, her crest drooped
6	Kemi stops in the middle of ‘I kn…’ and asks.	Why was this a big moment for Kemi?	first time she asked, she didn’t know
7	Sabu’s eyes sparkle: nobody had ever asked him.	How did Sabu feel when Kemi asked him?	happy, special, proud
8	Each question opens like a little door.	What did Kemi find behind the doors?	beetles roll backwards, grandma’s song, new things
9	A cloud hides the stars; Kemi thinks ‘Who could I ask?’	Who could Kemi ask?	the jerboas, another animal Go further: What did she do differently this time?
11	Stars above, the Nile below.	How did asking help Kemi get home?	Sabu knew the stars, the jerboas knew the shortcut

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don’t need every stop.

Handle with care: Knowing things is good. Keep the message that asking first is better, not that knowing is bad. More notes on the “For every child” page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

ask

to say a question so you can find out

Do it: lift one hand, palm up

dune

a big hill of sand

Do it: draw a wave in the air

crest

the feathers on top of a bird's head

Do it: spread your fingers on top of your head

shortcut

a quicker way to get somewhere

Do it: zip your finger in a straight line

guide

to show someone the way

Do it: point ahead and walk two fingers

Roll, roll, look up!

Say it together whenever it comes up in the story.

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Telling shows what you know. Asking helps you grow.

Roll, roll, look up!

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How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



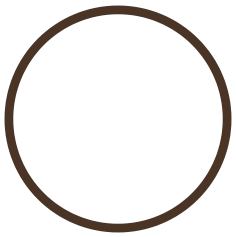
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

clip your name here

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Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Ask first circle

10 minutes, Pairs, Materials: None

Partners take turns asking each other one question (‘What do you like to play?’) and listening to the whole answer before talking. Then each child tells the class one new thing they learned about their partner.

Roll backwards like Sabu

10 minutes, Small groups, Materials: A soft ball, a tape path

Children push a ball along a path with their feet, walking backwards, like a dung beetle. A partner ‘looks up’ and guides with words: left, right, straight. Swap roles.

River of stars

15 minutes, Whole class, Materials: Dark paper, white chalk or star stickers

Make a long strip of night sky with a ‘river of stars’ across it. Each child adds a star with a question they want to ask someone this week.

Science and nature corner

Hoopoes live across Africa, Europe and Asia and are common in Egypt. They raise their crest when excited and poke their long bills into the ground to find insects. Dung beetles roll balls of dung backwards, standing on their front legs and pushing with their back legs. Scientists have found that some dung beetles can use the glow of the Milky Way to roll in a straight line at night. Jerboas are desert rodents that hop on long back legs.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. Why did Kemi's friends stop talking when she came near?

Look for: She only told, never asked, so there was no room for their words.

2. How did Kemi feel when she didn't know the way?

Look for: Lost, worried, a bit scared. Accept any feeling word.

3. What happened when she asked Sabu a question?

Look for: He was happy to be asked and showed her the river of stars.

4. Who knew the shortcut? How did they feel being asked?

Look for: The jerboas. They loved being asked.

5. What question could you ask a friend today?

Look for: Any answer. Try it at playtime.



Say it together

Roll, roll, look up!

The big idea: Asking makes room for other people's words, and it takes you farther than telling.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show asking and listening this week. Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show asking and listening by

Name _____



I can show asking and listening by

Name _____



I can show asking and listening by

Name _____



I can show asking and listening by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Belonging and Contributing	Problem Solving and Innovating	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Notes

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Science and place corner

The story doesn't name a town, so we picked a real place where everything in it happens side by side: Aswan in southern Egypt, where green palm islands sit in the Nile and golden dunes come right down to the river.



Eurasian hoopoe

From about six days old, hoopoe chicks have a trick: they turn around and squirt their poop at anything that pokes into the nest, while hissing like a snake!



Sacred scarab (dung beetle)

In 2013 scientists showed that dung beetles can keep a straight path using the glowing band of the Milky Way. It was the first animal ever shown to use the Milky Way to find its way!



Pied kingfisher

Young birds, often sons of the father, help raise the new chicks by bringing food. Most pied kingfishers are males!



Nile grass frogs

Egypt is mostly desert, but the Nile works like a green road that lets frogs from tropical Africa live far to the north.



Lesser Egyptian jerboa

A lesser Egyptian jerboa can leap up to three metres in one bound. That's like you jumping across a bus!

The Nile at Aswan, Egypt

Kemi: A real hoopoe's crest really does pop up when it is excited. But a real hoopoe eats insects, so in real life Sabu might want to keep his distance! And real hoopoes don't say "I know!" (as far as we know).

Sabu: Real dung beetles really steer by the Milky Way, but the beetle tested was a South African cousin that rolls at night. The sacred scarab of Egypt mostly works in the daytime, using the sun. And Sabu's golden star is our artist's idea.

The kingfisher: Pied kingfishers really are black and white, chatty and great at diving. In the story the kingfisher only talks about fishing. A real one would happily eat a little frog now and then!

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-beetle-who-knew-the-stars

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. Model the question frame ‘How do you…?’ and let children use it with a picture prompt. ‘Pop!’ is easy for everyone to join.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 3, 6 and 11). Act out ‘telling’ and ‘asking’ with a puppet so the difference is clear.

Mixed ages and older children

Older children make a ‘question door’ booklet: each page is a door with a question on the front and the answer they found behind it.

Handle with care

Knowing things is good. Keep the message that asking first is better, not that knowing is bad.

Children who are shy may find asking hard. Let them ask a puppet or write a question first.

Being lost at night can worry some children. Kemi is never alone for long: Sabu’s song comes right away.

Where this value comes from

More than 4,000 years ago in ancient Egypt, a wise man named Ptahhotep wrote a book of advice, one of the oldest in the world. His first piece of advice was: don’t be proud of what you know; ask everyone, because anyone can teach you something.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read The Beetle Who Knew the Stars, a story about asking before telling. Kemi the hoopoe loves to tell everyone what she knows, until she gets lost and finds that asking takes her farther. At home, take turns asking each other one question at dinner, and listen to the whole answer. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu Le Scarabée qui connaissait les étoiles, une histoire sur l'importance de demander avant de dire. Kemi la huppe adore dire tout ce qu'elle sait, jusqu'au jour où elle se perd et découvre que poser des questions la mène plus loin. À la maison, posez-vous une question chacun votre tour au repas, et écoutez toute la réponse. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre preguntar antes de decir. Kemi, la abubilla, ama decirle a todos lo que sabe, hasta que se pierde y descubre que preguntar la lleva más lejos. En casa, túrnense para hacerse una pregunta en la cena y escuchen toda la respuesta. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte darüber gelesen, erst zu fragen und dann zu erzählen. Der Wiedehopf Kemi erzählt allen gern, was sie weiß, bis sie sich verirrt und merkt, dass Fragen sie weiter bringt. Stellen Sie sich zu Hause beim Abendessen abwechselnd eine Frage und hören Sie die ganze Antwort an. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sul chiedere prima di dire. Kemi, l'upupa, ama dire a tutti quello che sa, finché si perde e scopre che fare domande la porta più lontano. A casa, a cena, fatevi a turno una domanda e ascoltate tutta la risposta. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Asking and listening: I can

- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Asking and listening: I can

- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Asking and listening: I can

- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Asking and listening: I can

- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .
- ☐ I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: asking and listening.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Asking makes room for other people's words, and it takes you farther than telling.

Say it together

Roll, roll, look up!

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
ask	to say a question so you can find out	lift one hand, palm up
dune	a big hill of sand	draw a wave in the air
crest	the feathers on top of a bird's head	spread your fingers on top of your head
shortcut	a quicker way to get somewhere	zip your finger in a straight line
guide	to show someone the way	point ahead and walk two fingers

A gentle note

Knowing things is good. Keep the message that asking first is better, not that knowing is bad.

Children who are shy may find asking hard. Let them ask a puppet or write a question first.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Kemi

Eurasian hoopoe

Knows lots of things and learns to ask first



Sabu

Sacred scarab (dung beetle)

The quiet friend who looks up at the sky



The kingfisher

Pied kingfisher

The chatty fisher on the papyrus stem



The two frogs

Nile grass frogs

The cheerful croakers on the mud bank



The jerboa family

Lesser Egyptian jerboa

The desert bouncers who know the way

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How did they feel?

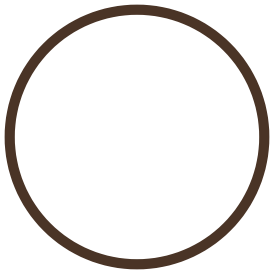
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Kemi tells everyone how to do things; her friends go quiet.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

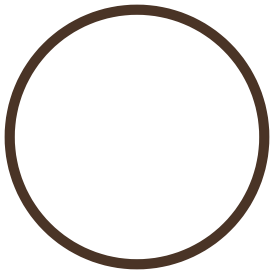


Moment 2

Sabu's eyes sparkle: nobody had ever asked him.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

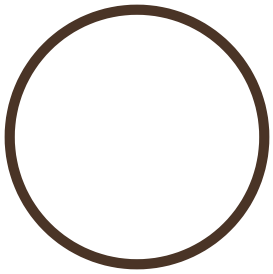


Moment 3

Stars above, the Nile below.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

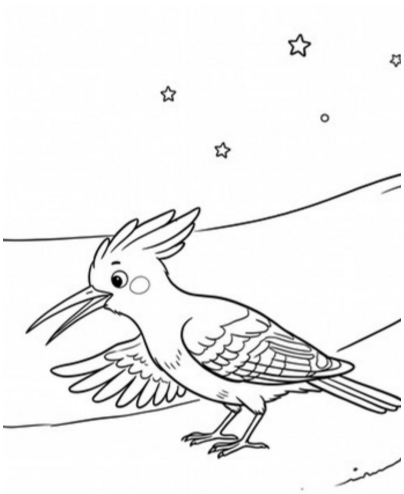
sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

ask to say a question so you can find out

ask ask

dune a big hill of sand

dune dune

crest the feathers on top of a bird's head

crest crest

Kemi the hero of the story

Kemi Kemi

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Kemi showed asking and listening. Draw a time when you showed asking and listening too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Ask first circle

You need: None

Partners take turns asking each other one question (‘What do you like to play?’) and listening to the whole answer before talking. Then each child tells the class one new thing they learned about their partner.

Ask, don't tell

Play with a grown-up: for five minutes, you can only ask questions. What did you learn about them?

Roll like Sabu

Roll a ball backwards with your feet in a straight line. Is it harder than it looks?

Find the river of stars

On a dark, clear night away from city lights, look for a pale, cloudy band across the sky. That's the Milky Way.

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The Beetle Who Knew the Stars are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Kemi

Eurasian hoopoe

From about six days old, hoopoe chicks have a trick: they turn around and squirt their poop at anything that pokes into the nest, while hissing like a snake!



Sabu

Sacred scarab (dung beetle)

In 2013 scientists showed that dung beetles can keep a straight path using the glowing band of the Milky Way. It was the first animal ever shown to use the Milky Way to find its way!



The kingfisher

Pied kingfisher

Young birds, often sons of the father, help raise the new chicks by bringing food. Most pied kingfishers are males!



The two frogs

Nile grass frogs

Egypt is mostly desert, but the Nile works like a green road that lets frogs from tropical Africa live far to the north.

Story or real?

A real hoopoe's crest really does pop up when it is excited. But a real hoopoe eats insects, so in real life Sabu might want to keep his distance! And real hoopoes don't say "I know!" (as far as we know).

Where they really live

The story doesn't name a town, so we picked a real place where everything in it happens side by side: Aswan in southern Egypt, where green palm islands sit in the Nile and golden dunes come right down to the river.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-beetle-who-knew-the-stars

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What is the beetle doing? Why might a beetle know about the stars?

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars, talk card 1

Why did Kemi's friends stop talking when she came near?

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars, talk card 2

How did Kemi feel when she didn't know the way?

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars, talk card 3

What happened when she asked Sabu a question?

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars, talk card 4

Who knew the shortcut? How did they feel being asked?

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars, talk card 5

What question could you ask a friend today?

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars, talk card 6

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Asking and listening hero

This is to say that

_____

showed asking and listening, just like Kemi.

Roll, roll, look up!

Signed _____ Date _____

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